EXERCISE 1

Direct Integration: General Solutions

Original statement · ProblemsCh2.pdf

Direct integration • Antiderivatives

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Find the general solution to the following equations:

(i) $y'(x) = e^{3x} - x$;
(ii) $x\,y'(x) = 1$;
(iii) $y'(x) = x\,e^{x^2}$;
(iv) $(1+x)\,y'(x) = x$;
(v) $(1+x^2)\,y'(x) = x$.

Source: ProblemsCh2.pdf, Exercise 1 (page 1).

PHASE 1: CLASSIFICATION, HYPOTHESES AND DOMAIN

Each equation is first order, explicit once the coefficient of y' is divided out, and the unknown y does not appear on the right-hand side:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = f(x).$$

- (i) $f(x) = e^{3x} - x$, continuous on $\mathbb{R}$.
- (ii) $f(x) = 1/x$, continuous on $(-\infty, 0)$ and on $(0, \infty)$; at $x = 0$ the equation reads $0 = 1$, so no solution can be defined at $x = 0$.
- (iii) $f(x) = xe^{x^2}$, continuous on $\mathbb{R}$.
- (iv) $f(x) = x/(1+x)$, continuous on $(-\infty, -1)$ and on $(-1, \infty)$; at $x = -1$ the equation reads $0 = -1$, so no solution can be defined at $x = -1$.
- (v) $f(x) = x/(1+x^2)$, continuous on $\mathbb{R}$ because $1 + x^2 \geq 1 > 0$.

Unknown: a function y differentiable on an interval I on which f is continuous. Because f does not depend on y, the right-hand side is trivially Lipschitz in y and the existence-uniqueness theorem (Robinson, Theorem 6.2) gives exactly one solution for each initial condition $y(x_0) = y_0$ on every such interval.

PHASE 2: CHOICE OF METHOD AND CHANGE OF VARIABLES

Why this method: when $y' = f(x)$ with f continuous on an interval, the Fundamental Theorem of Calculus gives an antiderivative F, and two antiderivatives on an interval differ by a constant (a function with zero derivative on an interval is constant, by the Mean Value Theorem). So direct integration produces all solutions.

Change of variables: none is needed for the equation itself. Where an integral is not immediate, a substitution is written explicitly: $u = 3x$ in (i), $u = x^2$ in (iii), $u = 1 + x^2$ in (v), and a polynomial division (rewriting $x = (1 + x) - 1$) in (iv). Constants of integration are attached separately on each interval of continuity.

$$y(x) = \int f(x)\,dx = F(x) + C.$$

PHASE 3: STEP-BY-STEP DERIVATION

Part (i): $y' = e^{3x} - x$

Integrate term by term:

$$y(x) = \int e^{3x}\,dx - \int x\,dx.$$

For the first integral put $u = 3x$, so $du = 3\,dx$ and $dx = du/3$:

$$\int e^{3x}\,dx = \frac{1}{3}\int e^{u}\,du = \frac{1}{3}e^{u} = \frac{1}{3}e^{3x}.$$

The second integral is $\int x\,dx = x^2/2$. Hence

$$y(x) = \frac{1}{3}e^{3x} - \frac{x^2}{2} + C, \qquad C \in \mathbb{R},\ x \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Part (ii): $x\,y' = 1$

On each interval $x \neq 0$ divide by x to get $y' = 1/x$. Then

$$y(x) = \int \frac{dx}{x} = \ln|x| + C.$$

The absolute value is needed: for $x > 0$, $\frac{d}{dx}\ln x = 1/x$; for $x < 0$, $\frac{d}{dx}\ln(-x) = \frac{-1}{-x} = \frac{1}{x}$. The two half-lines are not connected, so the constants are independent:

$$y(x) = \begin{cases} \ln x + C_1, & x > 0, \\ \ln(-x) + C_2, & x < 0, \end{cases} \qquad C_1, C_2 \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Part (iii): $y' = xe^{x^2}$

Substitute $u = x^2$, so $du = 2x\,dx$ and $x\,dx = du/2$:

$$y(x) = \int xe^{x^2}\,dx = \frac{1}{2}\int e^{u}\,du = \frac{1}{2}e^{u} + C = \frac{1}{2}e^{x^2} + C.$$

Part (iv): $(1+x)\,y' = x$

On each interval $x \neq -1$ divide by $1+x$ and rewrite the numerator as $x = (1+x) - 1$:

$$y'(x) = \frac{x}{1+x} = \frac{(1+x)-1}{1+x} = 1 - \frac{1}{1+x}.$$

Integrate, using $u = 1+x$, $du = dx$ for the second term:

$$y(x) = \int 1\,dx - \int \frac{du}{u} = x - \ln|1+x| + C.$$

Again the constants are independent on $(-\infty, -1)$ and on $(-1, \infty)$:

$$y(x) = x - \ln|1+x| + C_{\pm}.$$

Part (v): $(1+x^2)\,y' = x$

Since $1+x^2>0$ on all of $\mathbb{R}$, divide: $y'=x/(1+x^2)$. Substitute $u=1+x^2$, so $du=2x\,dx$ and $x\,dx=du/2$:

$$y(x)=\int \frac{x\,dx}{1+x^2}=\frac{1}{2}\int\frac{du}{u}=\frac{1}{2}\ln|u|+C=\frac{1}{2}\ln(1+x^2)+C.$$

No absolute value is needed because $u=1+x^2>0$.

PHASE 4: VERIFICATION, LIMITS AND INTERPRETATION

Check each result by differentiating (chain rule written out):

- (i) $\frac{d}{dx}\left[\frac{1}{3}e^{3x}-\frac{x^2}{2}+C\right]=\frac{1}{3}\cdot 3e^{3x}-x=e^{3x}-x.$
- (ii) $x\cdot\frac{d}{dx}\ln|x|=x\cdot\frac{1}{x}=1$ for $x\neq 0$.
- (iii) $\frac{d}{dx}\left[\frac{1}{2}e^{x^2}\right]=\frac{1}{2}e^{x^2}\cdot 2x=xe^{x^2}.$
- (iv) $(1+x)\,\frac{d}{dx}\left[x-\ln|1+x|\right]=(1+x)\left(1-\frac{1}{1+x}\right)=(1+x)-1=x.$
- (v) $(1+x^2)\,\frac{d}{dx}\left[\frac{1}{2}\ln(1+x^2)\right]=(1+x^2)\cdot\frac{1}{2}\cdot\frac{2x}{1+x^2}=x.$

Symbolic check with sympy (dsolve and differentiation of the closed forms) reproduces the five results above.

Domain remarks: the solutions of (i), (iii), (v) are defined on all of $\mathbb{R}$. For (ii) and (iv) the solution cannot be extended through $x=0$ and $x=-1$ respectively, because the equation itself is inconsistent there ($0=1$ and $0=-1$), and $\ln|x|$, $\ln|1+x|$ are unbounded at those points. The equations in (iv) and (v) look similar but behave differently: only (iv) has a singular point, since $1+x$ vanishes at $x=-1$ whereas $1+x^2$ never vanishes.

RESULTS

Part	General solution	Domain
(i)	$y=\frac{1}{3}e^{3x}-\frac{1}{2}x^2+C$	$\mathbb{R}$
(ii)	$y=\ln\|x\|+C_{\pm}$	$x\neq 0$
(iii)	$y=\frac{1}{2}e^{x^2}+C$	$\mathbb{R}$
(iv)	$y=x-\ln\|1+x\|+C_{\pm}$	$x\neq -1$
(v)	$y=\frac{1}{2}\ln(1+x^2)+C$	$\mathbb{R}$